Annual Technology & Infrastructure Report 2025

PayStream Inc. annual technology report for the fiscal year ending December 31, 2025. This document is prepared for the Board of Directors and is confidential. It covers cloud infrastructure, technology spend, and operational risks.

Company Profile

Company: PayStream Inc.

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Technology Spend Overview

PayStream's total technology spend for 2025 was $4.8M, of which cloud infrastructure represents $341,400 (28.6% of total technology spend and 1.9% of ARR). Cloud costs grew 41% year-over-year, significantly outpacing revenue growth of 22%. The CTO has flagged cloud cost discipline as a critical initiative for 2026.

MONTHLY CLOUD	ANNUAL CLOUD	CLOUD/REVENUE	YOY GROWTH
$28,450	$341,400	1.9%	+41%
December 2025	FY 2025	of ARR	cloud costs

Cloud Infrastructure -- Provider Breakdown

Provider	Monthly Spend	Annual Spend	% Share	Primary Workloads
AWS	$19,400	$232,800	68.2%	Payments, Auth, Notifications
Azure	$7,450	$89,400	26.2%	KYC verification
GCP	$1,600	$19,200	5.6%	ML fraud scoring
TOTAL	$28,450	$341,400	100%	

Infrastructure Workloads

System	Provider	Region	Monthly Cost	Status

Payment API Gateway	AWS	us-east-1	$5,800	Production
User Auth Service	AWS	us-east-1	$2,900	Production
Transaction Ledger	AWS	eu-west-1	$7,200	Production
KYC Verification Service	Azure	eastus2	$2,400	Production
Notification Engine	AWS	us-east-1	$900	Production
Analytics Pipeline	AWS	us-east-1	$3,800	Production
ML Fraud Scorer	GCP	us-central1	$1,600	Production
Dev Environment (untagged)	AWS	us-east-1	$2,100	Unmanaged
Staging (2024 launch)	AWS	us-east-2	$1,700	Unmanaged

Technology Risk Disclosures

1. Data Residency & GDPR Compliance

PayStream processes transaction data for approximately 180,000 European customers through its Analytics Pipeline, which operates on AWS infrastructure in the US East region. Legal counsel has advised that the current configuration may not satisfy GDPR Chapter V requirements for international data transfers following the Schrems II ruling. No Standard Contractual Clauses have been executed with AWS for this data category. Remediation is planned for Q1 2026 but has not commenced.

2. PCI-DSS Compliance Scope

An internal audit in October 2025 identified that two unmanaged development environments (listed above as 'Unmanaged' status) share network infrastructure with the Transaction Ledger, a PCI-DSS in-scope system. This expands the cardholder data environment boundary to include resources not subject to PCI-DSS controls. The company's QSA has been notified; formal remediation plan is pending Board approval.

3. Infrastructure Cost Overrun

Cloud spending exceeded the 2025 budget of $290,000 by $51,400 (17.7%). The overrun was driven primarily by GPU compute costs for the ML Fraud Scorer and unexpected data transfer charges from the Analytics Pipeline. The 2026 cloud budget has been set at $380,000 with a mandatory cost optimisation review in Q2 2026.

2026 Technology Priorities

1. Cloud cost optimisation programme -- target 20% reduction in cloud spend by Q3 2026
2. GDPR remediation -- migrate Analytics Pipeline to EU region
3. PCI-DSS environment isolation -- separate dev from production networking
4. Evaluate consolidation of ML Fraud Scorer onto primary AWS infrastructure
5. Implement cloud resource tagging policy (currently 34% of resources are untagged)
6. Evaluate transition from Auth0 to Cognito for cost and vendor consolidation